

Product Sales Project

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2025-09-16

Introduction

A new line of office stationery were launched 6 weeks ago. In focus to optimize the sales and revenues for our company three sales strategies were implemented: Email, Call and Email + Call. In this report we analyze the effectiveness of these strategies and insights which may be the best strategy in the future.

The following report is divided in:

- Data Validation and cleaning process of the dataset.
- Exploratory Analysis of the different variables, their differences and their relationships.
- Definition of a metric for our buissnes to monitor and assess the efectiviness in the future.
- Final summary and recomendations

Data Validation

The data recieved consist in 8 variables with 15,000 observation or registers. The variables are the following:

- **week:** Week sale was made, counted as weeks since product launch, stored as a integer, but acts as a category nominal level. From 1 to 6. No empty values were identified in this column. No modifications were necessary
- **sales_method:** This column is stored as a caracter, so an adjustment was employed to store as a factor with three nominal categories: “Email”, “Call”, “Email + Call”. In the validation process were identified some misspeled words such as “em + call” and “email”, so an unification were employed to fit this categories in their correct factor. No empty values were identified in this column. A total of 3 groups and 15,000 regisers in total were confirmed.
- **customer_id:** This is unique for each customer. No duplicates or missing values were identified. No changes were necessary.
- **nb_sold:** Number of units sold. The number of products needs to be a integer. No double (continuous) numbers or empty values were identified. No changes were necessary in this column.
- **revenue:** Revenue from the sales, rounded to 2 decimal places. 1074 empty values were identified as NA, and replaced with the mean of the non-na values. No other changes on this column were necessary.
- **year_as_customer:** Number of years that a customer has been buying from our stores. As the maximum value coherent in this case is 41 (accordingly with the foundation year 1984), two abnormal outliers were identified and replaced with the maximum value possible 41. No missing values were identified and no other changes were necessary.
- **nb_site_visits:** The number of visits in our website in the last 6 months that a customer has made. No missing values were identified and no changes where necessary.

- **state**: States of the United States as a full name. This column is stored as a character, so an adjustment was employed to store as a factor with 50 different countries identified.

```
##      week      sales_method customer_id      nb_sold
## Min.   :1.000      Email      :7466      Length:15000      Min.    : 7.00
## 1st Qu.:2.000      Call      :4962      Class :character    1st Qu.: 9.00
## Median :3.000      Email + Call:2572      Mode  :character    Median :10.00
## Mean   :3.098                                     Mean   :10.08
## 3rd Qu.:5.000                                     3rd Qu.:11.00
## Max.   :6.000                                     Max.   :16.00
##
##      revenue      years_as_customer nb_site_visits      state
## Min.    : 32.54      Min.      : 0.000      Min.      :12.00      California :1872
## 1st Qu.: 53.04      1st Qu.: 1.000      1st Qu.:23.00      Texas      :1187
## Median : 91.86      Median : 3.000      Median :25.00      New York   : 965
## Mean    : 93.93      Mean    : 4.964      Mean    :24.99      Florida    : 904
## 3rd Qu.:106.07      3rd Qu.: 7.000      3rd Qu.:27.00      Illinois   : 617
## Max.    :238.32      Max.     :41.000      Max.     :41.00      Pennsylvania: 598
##                                     (Other)    :8857
##
##      Email      Call Email + Call
##      7466      4962      2572
## [1] "The total of customers is 15000"
## [1] "The total of groups are 3"
## [1] "The total of individual customers is 15000"
## [1] "The total of duplicates is 0"
## [1] "The total of states is 50"
```

Table 1: Summary table of revenue

Sales Method	Number of customers	Mean Revenue	Median Revenue	SD of Revenue
Email	7466	96.90	94.28	10.83
Call	4962	49.29	49.94	12.12
Email + Call	2572	171.48	182.14	40.93

[!h]

Table 2: Summary table of number of new products sold

Sales Method	N. of customers	Mean of products sold	Median of products sold	SD of number of products sold
Email	7466	9.73	10	1.18
Call	4962	9.51	10	1.73
Email + Call	2572	12.23	12	1.93

[!h]

Table 3: Summary table of years as a customer

Sales Method	Number of customers	Mean of years	Median of years	SD of years
Email	7466	4.98	3	5.05
Call	4962	5.18	4	5.11
Email + Call	2572	4.51	3	4.76

[!h]

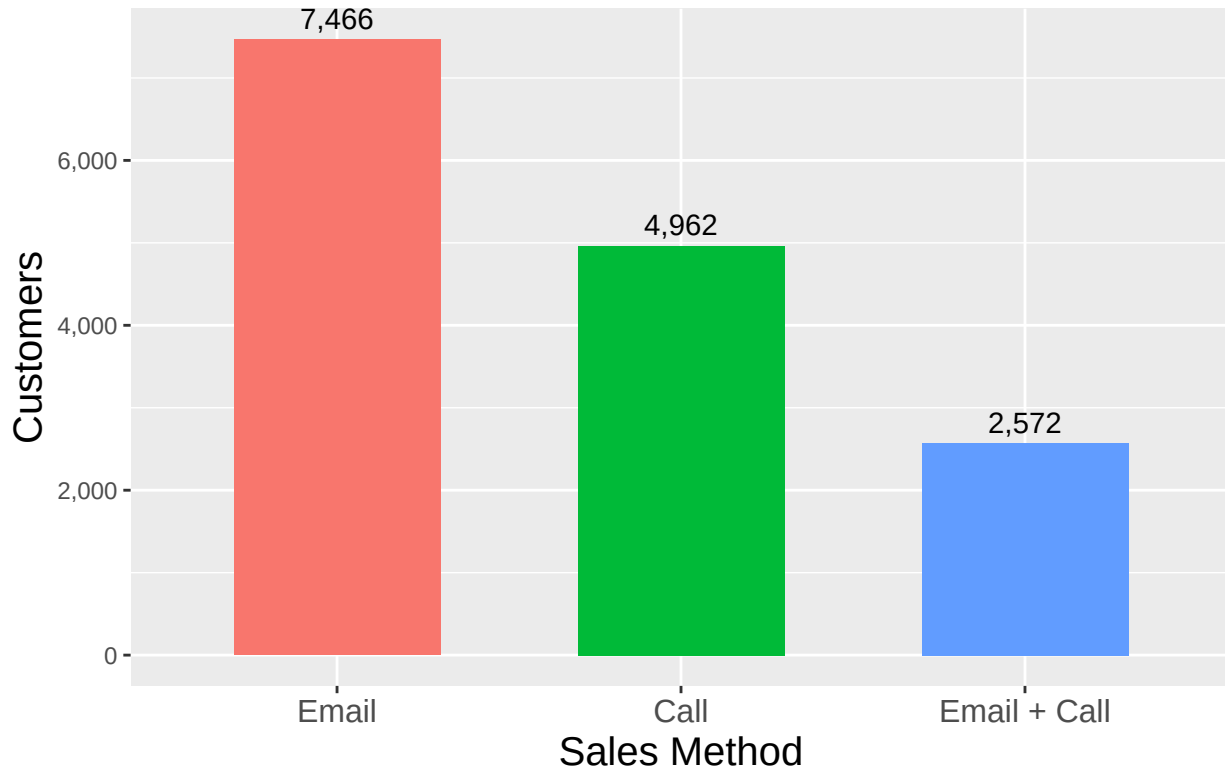
Table 4: Summary table of number of website visits

sales_method	Number of customers	Mean of visits	Median of visits	SD of visits
Email	7466	24.75	25	3.28
Call	4962	24.42	24	3.60
Email + Call	2572	26.77	27	3.36

1. Number of Customers for each Sales Method

A total of 15,000 customers were included in the analysis, these customers were assigned into one of the three sales strategies. The method with most customers was “Email” with 7,466 customers, followed by “Call” with 4962 customers and lastly “Email + Call” with 2572 customers.

Number of customers for each method

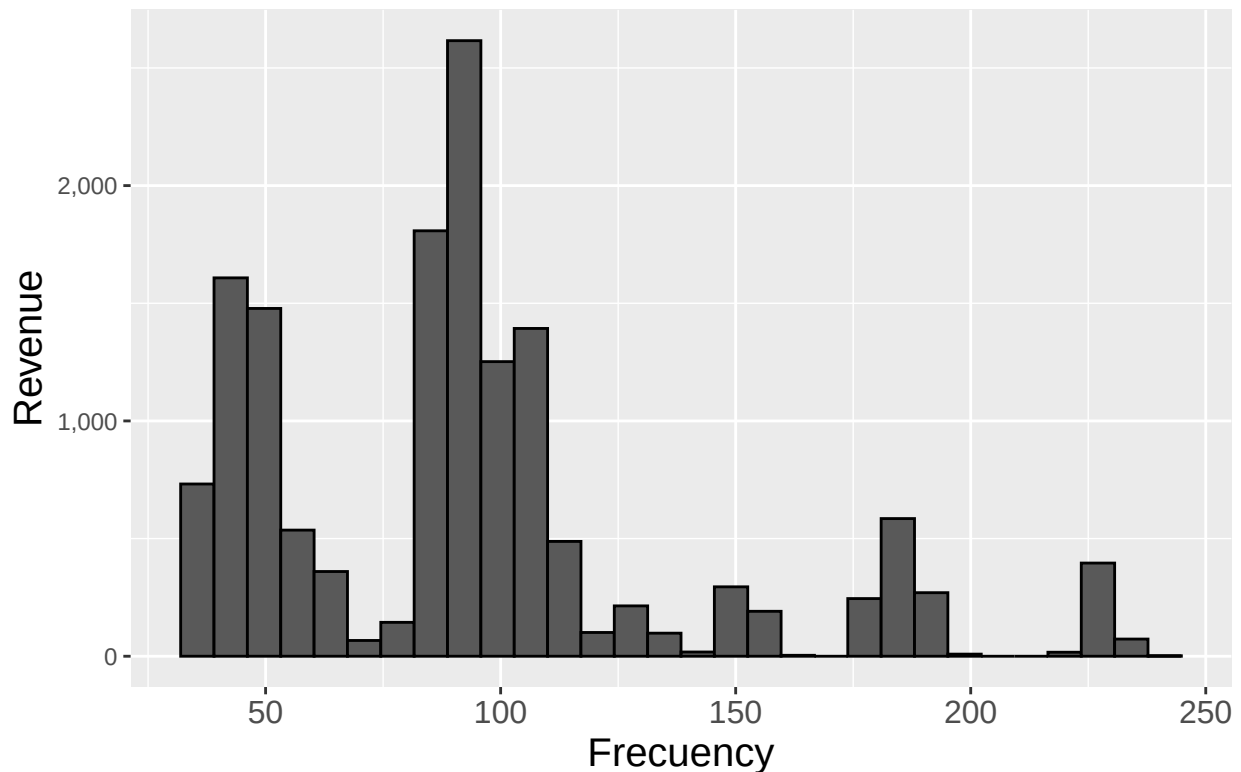


2. Spread of Revenue

2.1. Overall Spread of Revenue

The overall revenue indicates that most of the customers generated a revenue of 100 USD, while the overall revenue is skewed to the left indicates that the customers generated a revenue of less 100 USD, and some minority generated a revenue of a maximum of approximate 240 USD.

Overall Revenue Distribution

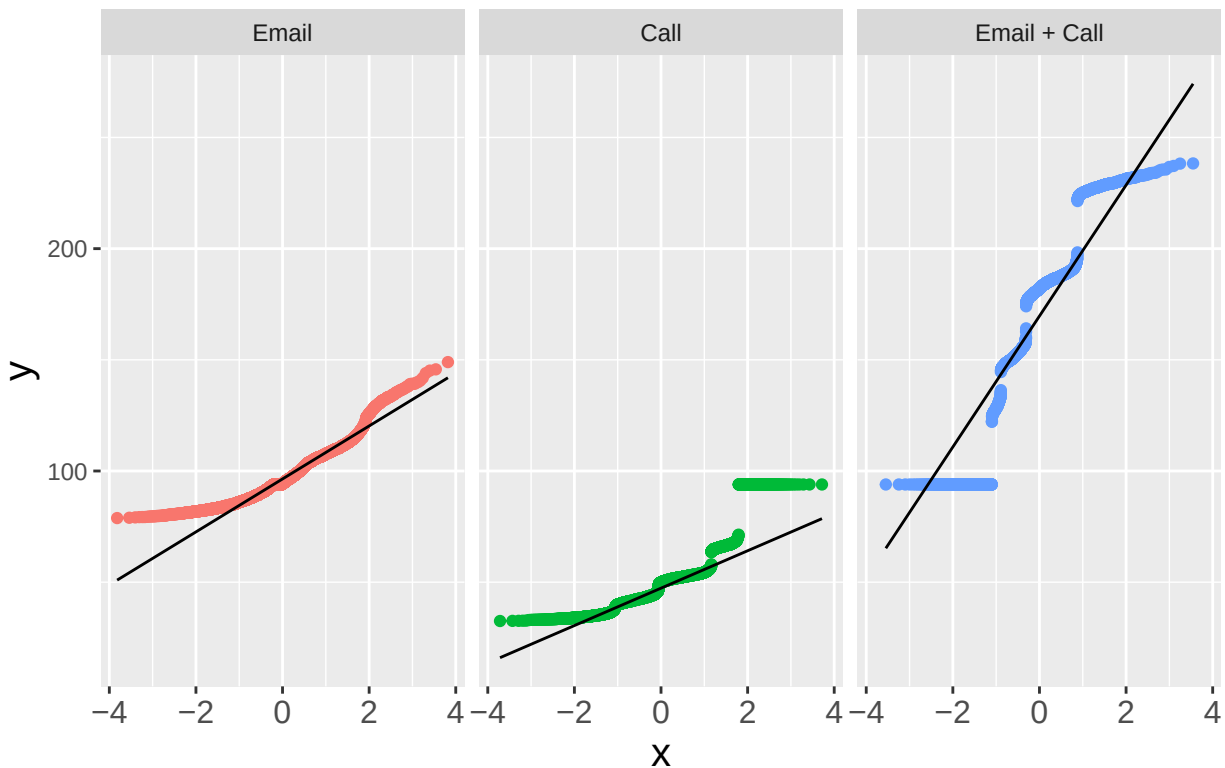


2.2 Spread of revenue for each sales method

To evaluate the spread of revenue for each method, a boxplot was created. To evaluate if the overall revenue grouped by each strategy a statistical test was used. To confirm the election for the statistical test a QQ plot and Levene test was employed, defining the election for Kruskal Wallis test, denoting that there is statistical difference between the customer revenue by each group and between all of them.

This means, the customers in the Email + Call group tended to generated more revenue, followed by the Email group, and lastly the customers in the Call group.

QQ-plot for revenue

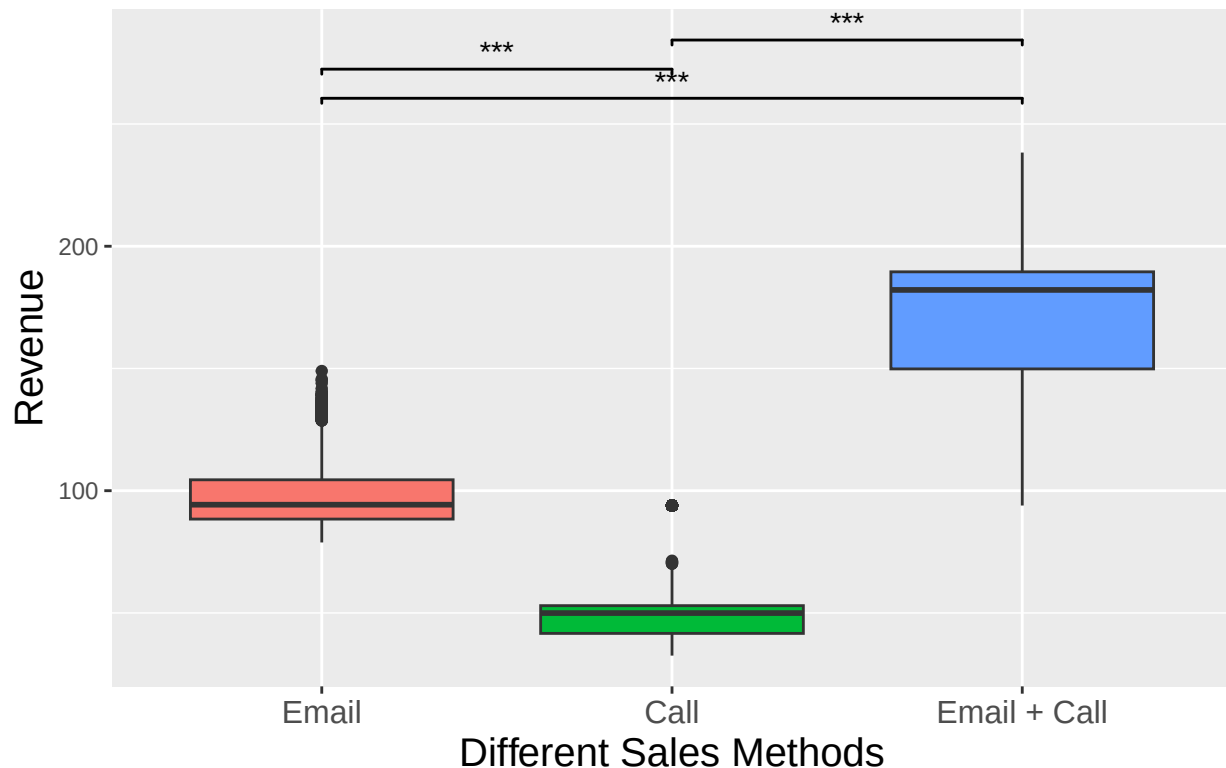


```
## Levene's Test for Homogeneity of Variance (center = median)
##           Df F value    Pr(>F)
## group      2  2826.1 < 2.2e-16 ***
##      14997
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

##
## Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test
##
## data:  revenue by sales_method
## Kruskal-Wallis chi-squared = 11375, df = 2, p-value < 2.2e-16

##
## Pairwise comparisons using Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data:  data_val$revenue and data_val$sales_method
##
##           Email  Call
## Call          <2e-16 -
## Email + Call <2e-16 <2e-16
##
## P value adjustment method: bonferroni
```

Revenue by Sales Methods



3. Differences in Revenue over Time for each sale strategy

The total revenue of the six weeks were \$1,409,024.14. Of this total, 51.34% were generated by the Email group, followed by the Email + Call group with 31.31% and lastly the Call group with 17.35%. Then I realize an analyze of the revenue into the six weeks. The findings are crucial to define which stratehy was more successful: - The Email method in the first week generated the highest revenue, with 84% of the revenue of that week. This indicate that at first week this method is the more efficient, but, after that, the Email method decreased substanciantly and in the sixth week the revenue was 1/10 of the first. - The Call method were constant and practically unifform with a discreate increasing just as the end of the fifth week, at sixth week the revenue decreased. This indicate that this method is constant the revenue is minnimal and over time tends to decrease. - The Email + Call Method started as the lowest revenue at the first week with just 6.2% of the first week revenue. However the tendency were a substancial increase in the revenue with a maximum point at the fifth week with 6.5 times the revenue of the first week of this method. At the last week the revenue presented a discrete decrease.

This analysis deluced that the Email + Call method is the most promising method as it takes 1/3 of the time call, and just more work for the email. The email method starts with the highest revenue, but declines just as the second week ends. And the Call method is constant but with no significant revenue. Posterior analysis are generated to clarify the most efficient method.

Total Revenue Over Time

Grouped by Sales Methods

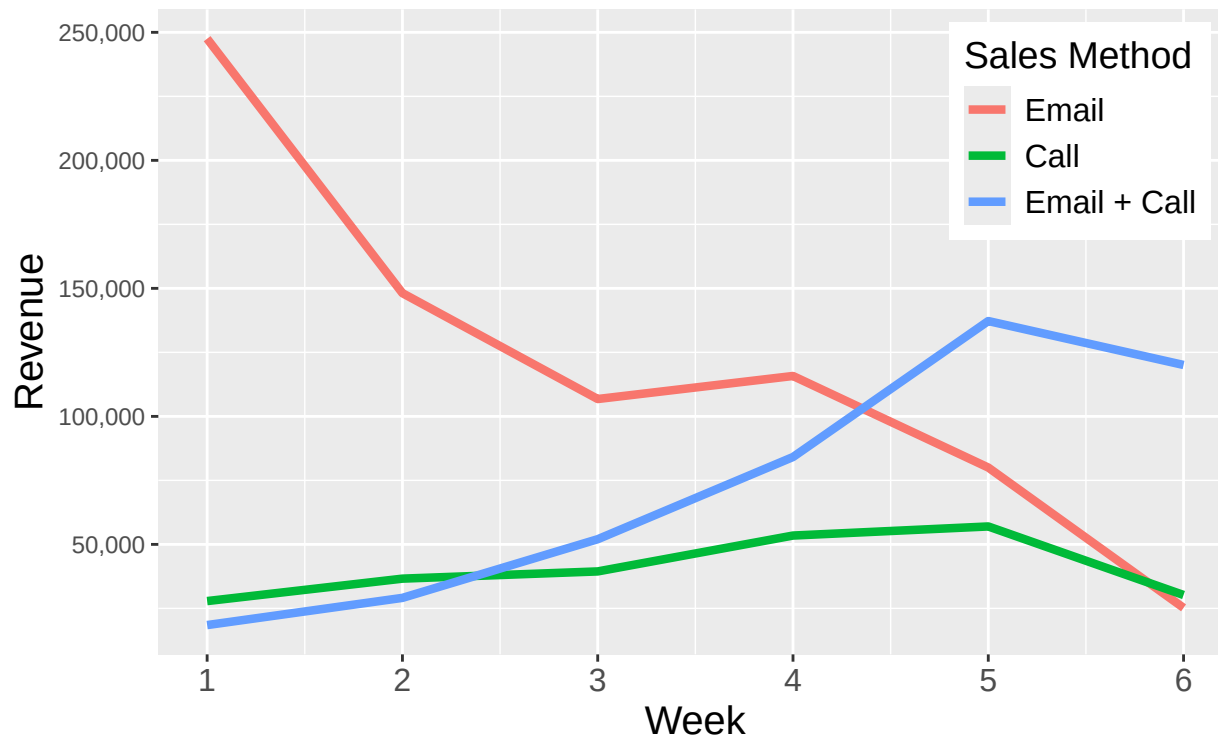
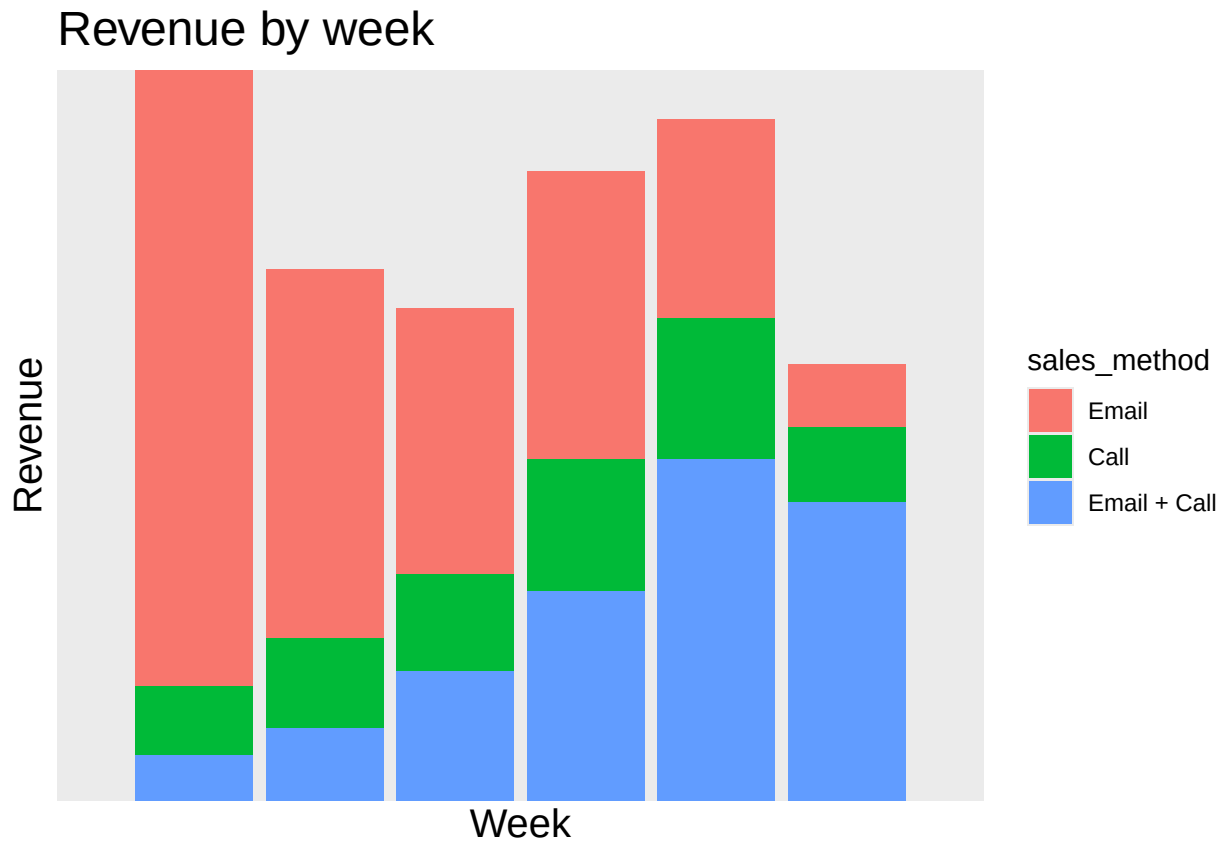


Table 5: Revenue over weeks

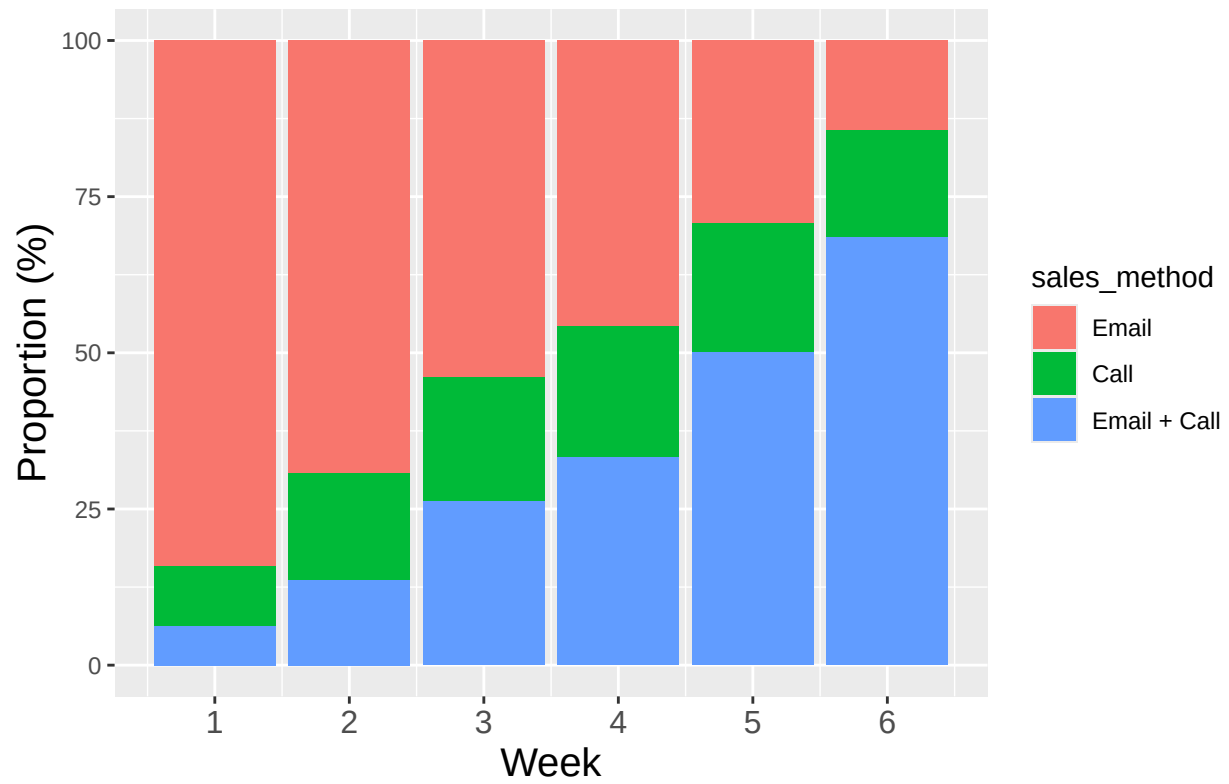
week	Email	Call	Email + Call	Total
1	247,519	27,850	18,482	293,851
2	148,130	36,610	29,100	213,841
3	106,777	39,441	52,025	198,243
4	115,773	53,445	84,120	253,338
5	80,010	56,994	137,236	274,240
6	25,210	30,226	120,076	175,511
Total	723,418	244,566	441,040	1,409,024

Table 6: Proportion of revenue over weeks

week	Email	Call	Email + Call	Total
1	84.23277	9.47758	6.289648	100
2	69.27135	17.12024	13.608409	100
3	53.86161	19.89536	26.243038	100
4	45.69890	21.09642	33.204674	100
5	29.17504	20.78244	50.042527	100
6	14.36359	17.22144	68.414963	100
Total	51.34181	17.35710	31.301095	100

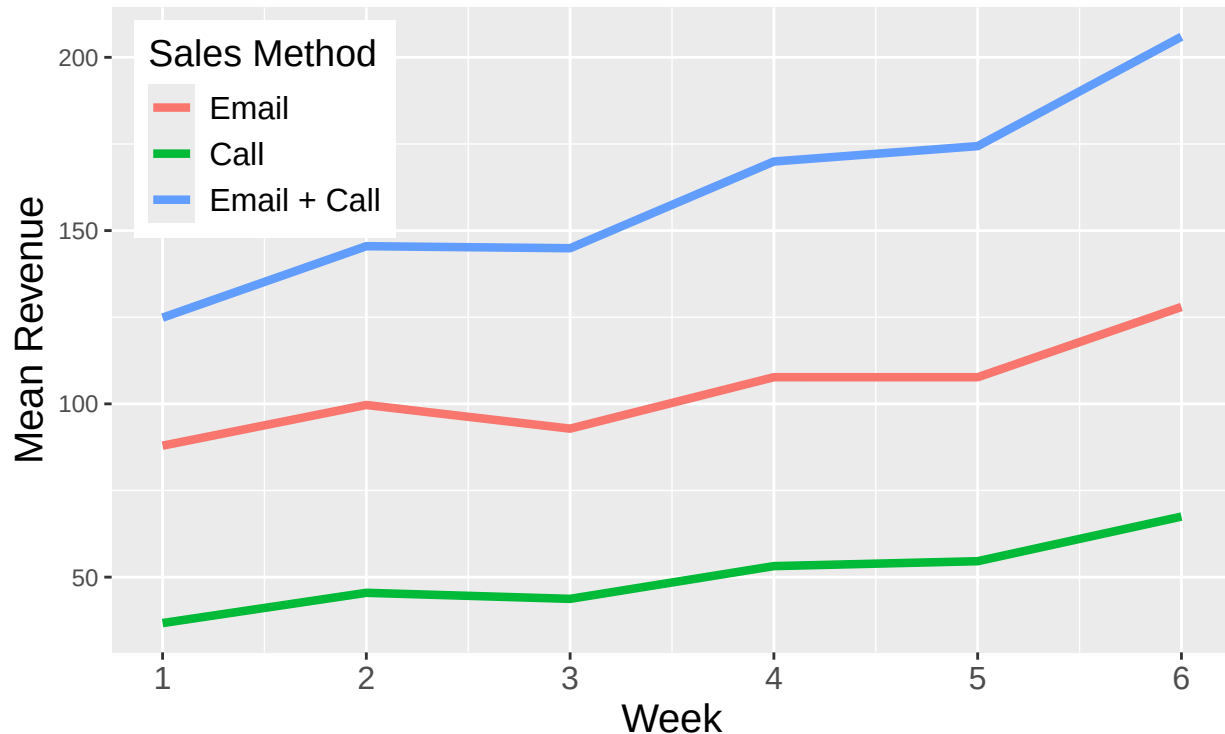


Proportion of Revenue by Sales Method



Mean Revenue Over Weeks

Grouped by Sales Methods



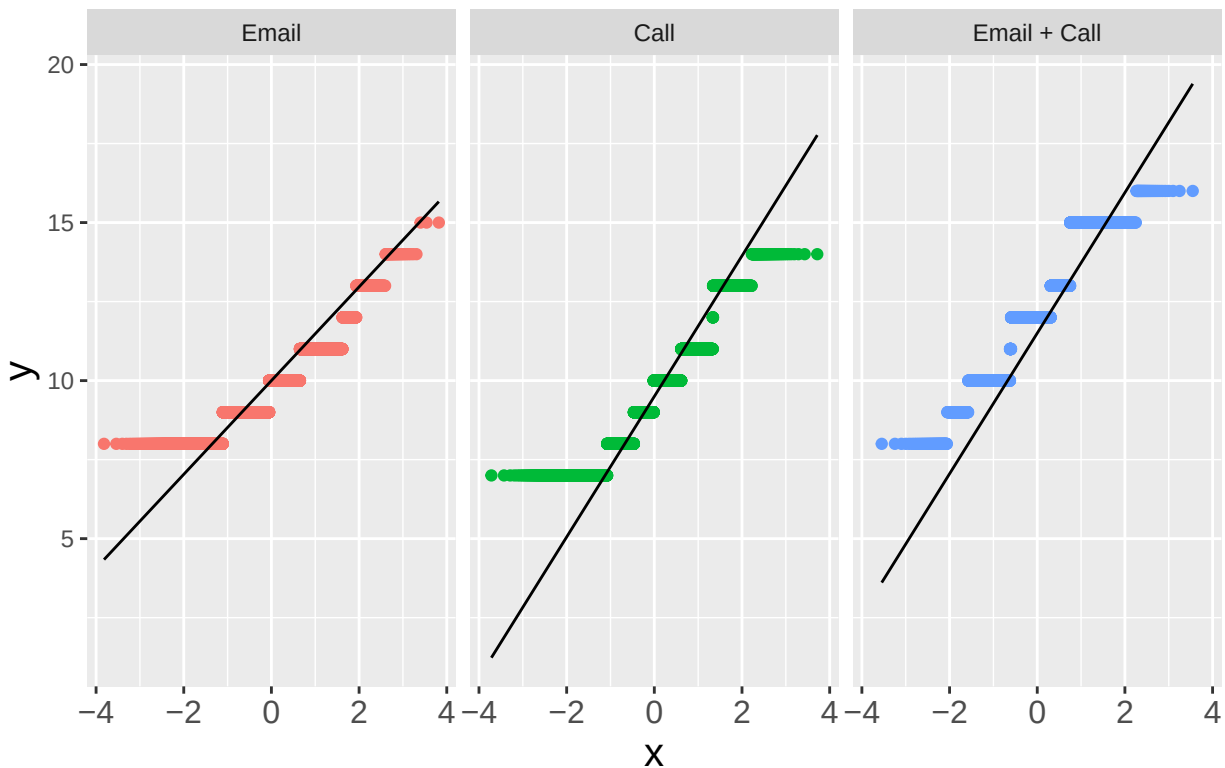
4. Other Differences between customers of each group

Then I compared three variables more to assess if there are differences between the groups. In all the cases assumption test were employed to evaluate the more accurate statistic test, in all cases the most appropriate was Kruskal Wallis test.

1. The number of units sold by each method was statistically different between all of them. The Email + Call method generated the major number of products sold with a mean of 12.23, at second place the Email method and the last place were the Call method with a mean of 9.73 and 9.51 respectively. This suggest that the customers contacted by Email + Call are more likely to buy more products per customer.
2. The years as a customer per method were statistically different between Call method vs Email and Email + Call, but comparing Email vs Email + Call resulted in non-statistical significance. This information suggest that the differences in other variables comparing Email vs Email + Call are not related with the number of years as a customer.
3. Then, I compared the number of visits to our website in the last 6 months, and identified that the Email + Call method again was the one with highest visits. Suggesting that this method not just only increases the number of products sold by customer also increases the number of visits in our website.

With this information we can conclude that the method Email + Call could be the most efficient of the three metrics considering all the variables evaluated.

QQ-plot for number of units sold



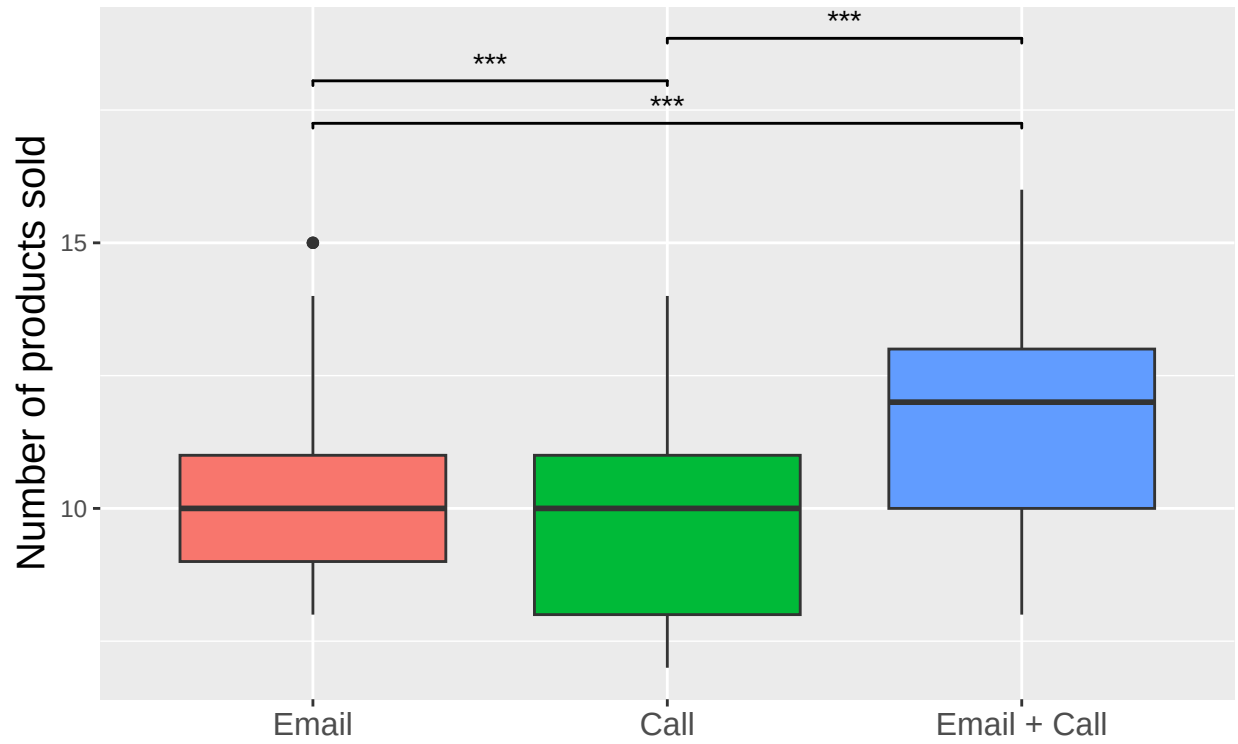
```
## Levene's Test for Homogeneity of Variance (center = median)
##           Df F value    Pr(>F)
## group      2  452.55 < 2.2e-16 ***
##      14997
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

##
## Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test
##
## data:  nb_sold by sales_method
## Kruskal-Wallis chi-squared = 3301.4, df = 2, p-value < 2.2e-16

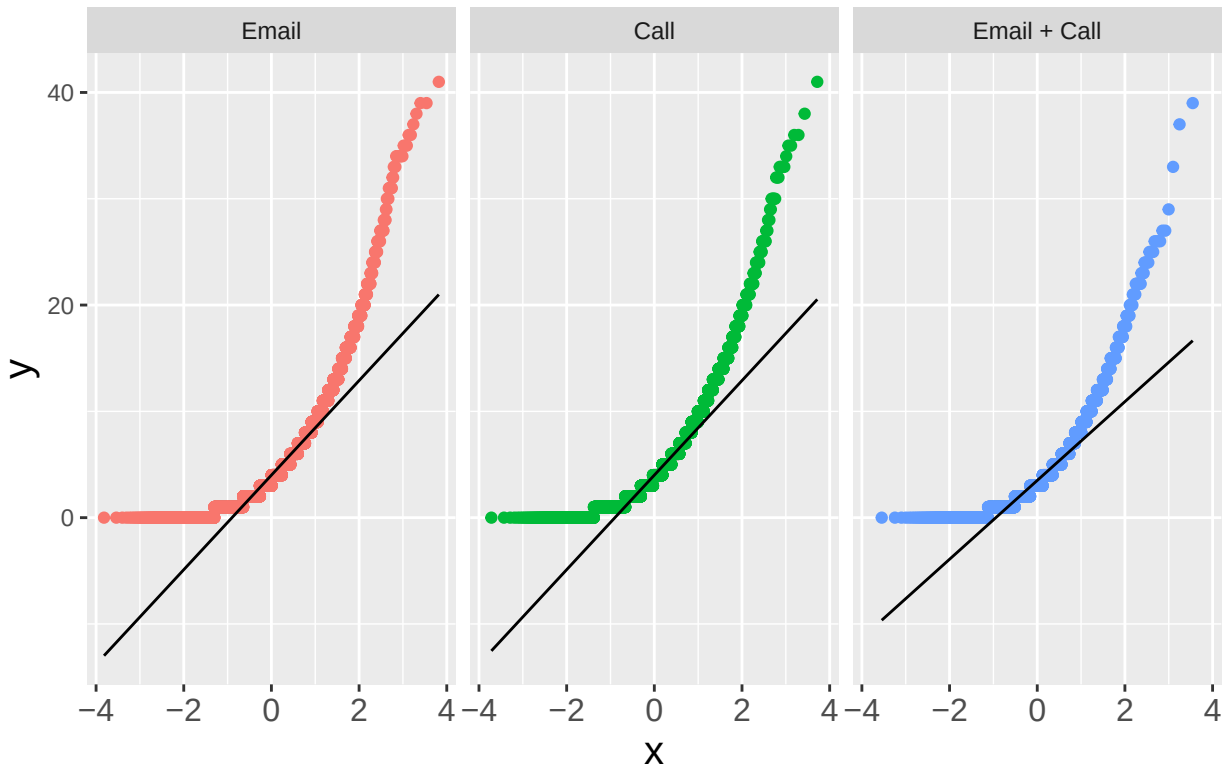
##
## Pairwise comparisons using Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data:  data_val$nb_sold and data_val$sales_method
##
##           Email  Call
## Call          <2e-16 -
## Email + Call <2e-16 <2e-16
##
## P value adjustment method: bonferroni
```

Number of New Products Sold

Grouped by sales method



QQ-plot for years as a customer



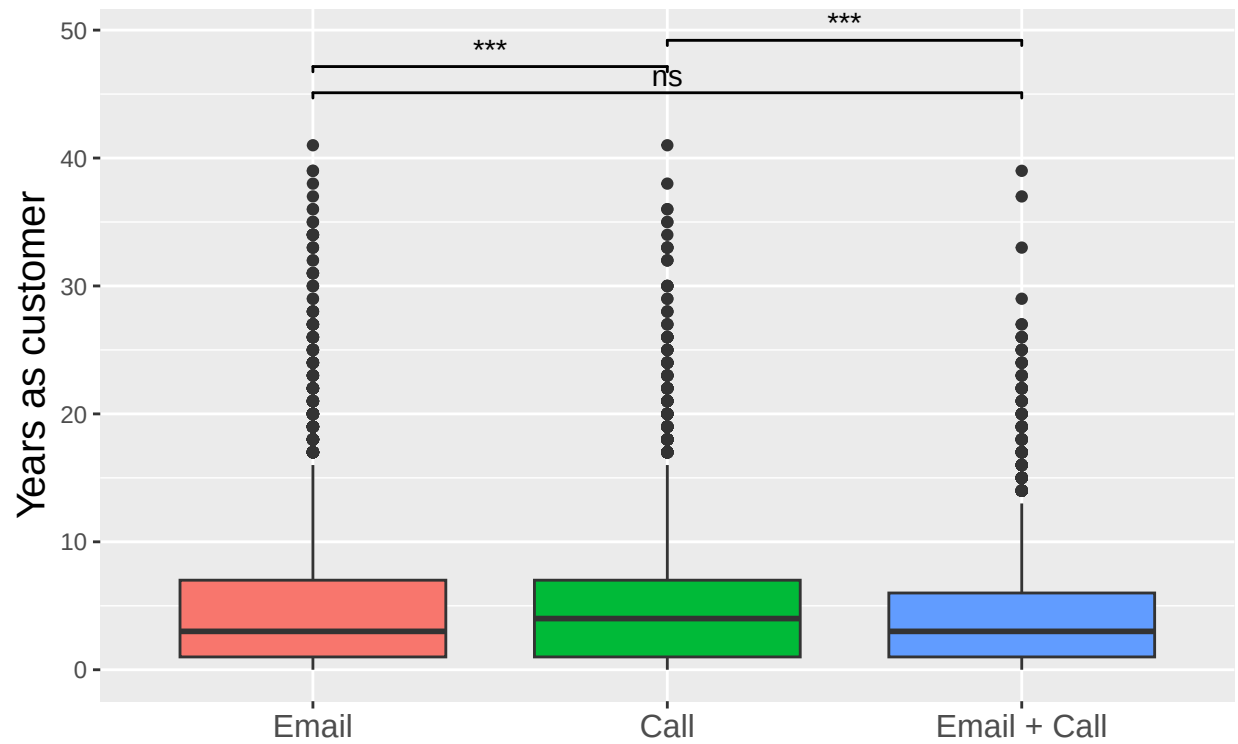
```
## Levene's Test for Homogeneity of Variance (center = median)
##           Df F value  Pr(>F)
## group      2  5.9914 0.002506 **
##      14997
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

##
## Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test
##
## data:  years_as_customer by sales_method
## Kruskal-Wallis chi-squared = 42.479, df = 2, p-value = 5.968e-10

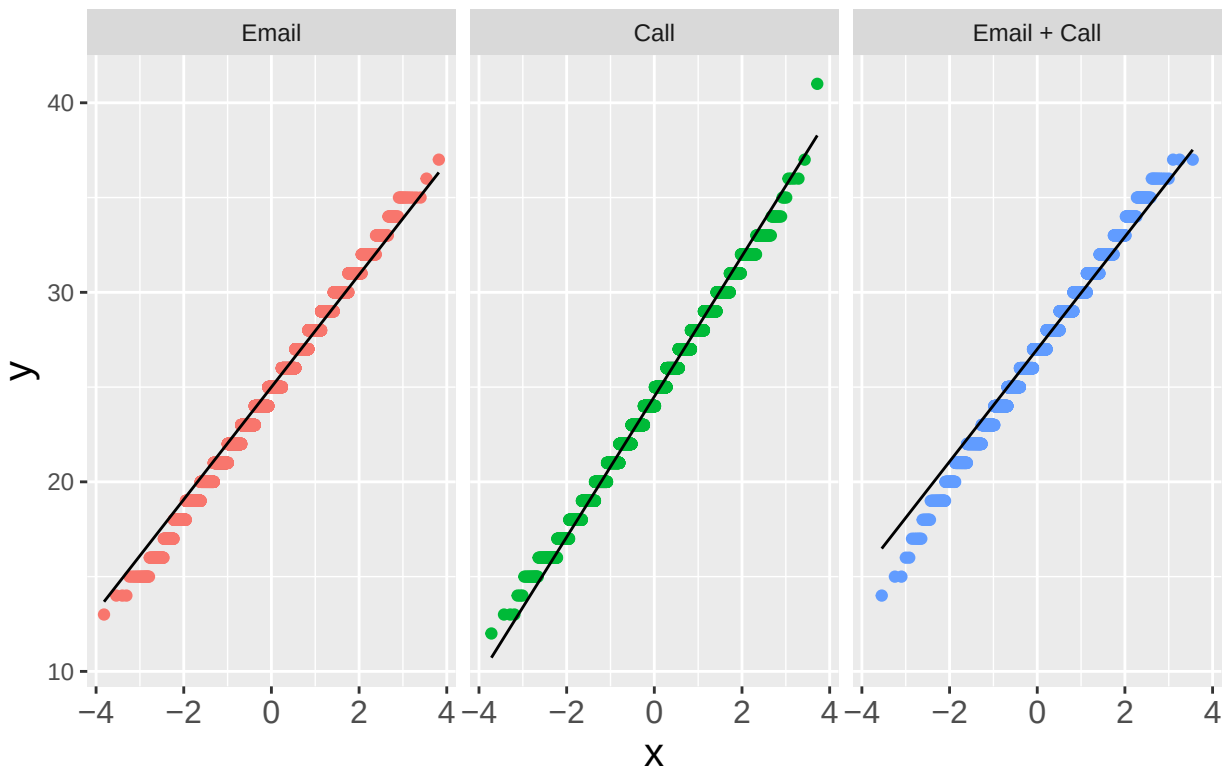
##
## Pairwise comparisons using Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data:  data_val$years_as_customer and data_val$sales_method
##
##           Email    Call
## Call      0.066    -
## Email + Call 1.2e-06 3.1e-10
##
## P value adjustment method: bonferroni
```

Years as customer

Grouped by sales method



QQ-plot for revenue



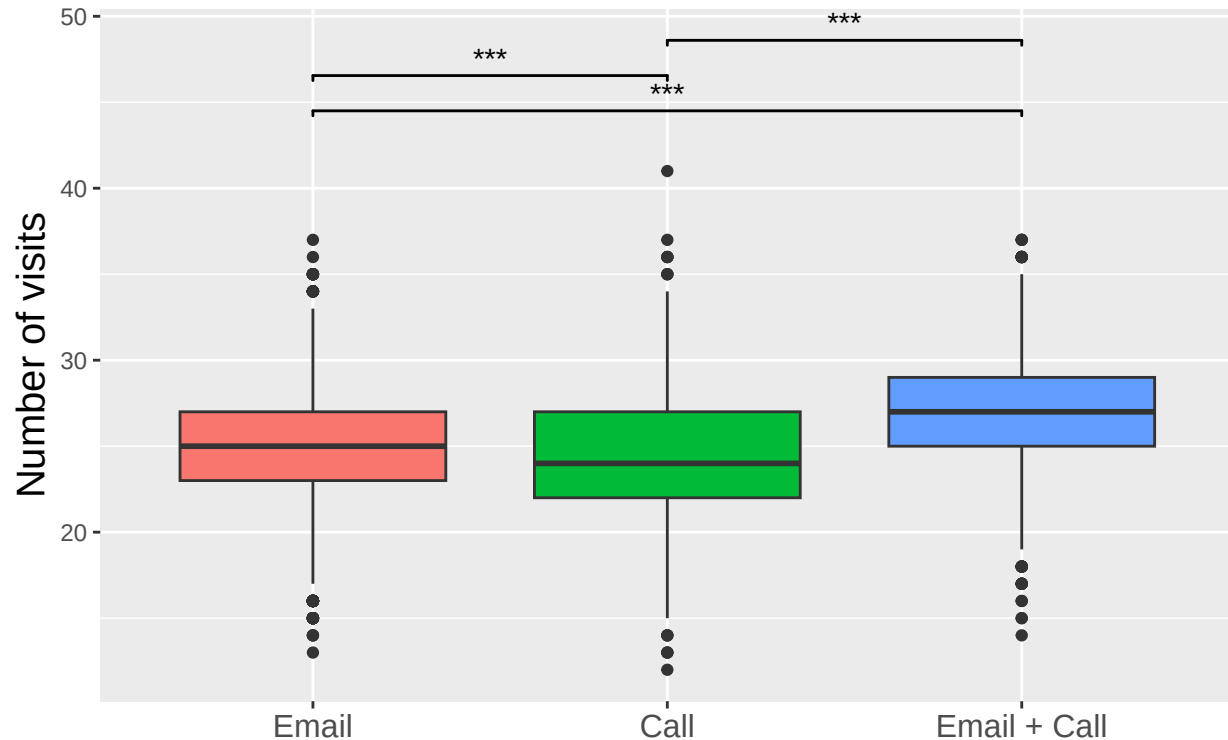
```
## Levene's Test for Homogeneity of Variance (center = median)
##           Df F value    Pr(>F)
## group      2  33.847 2.154e-15 ***
##      14997
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

##
## Kruskal-Wallis rank sum test
##
## data:  nb_site_visits by sales_method
## Kruskal-Wallis chi-squared = 796.26, df = 2, p-value < 2.2e-16

##
## Pairwise comparisons using Wilcoxon rank sum test with continuity correction
##
## data:  data_val$nb_site_visits and data_val$sales_method
##
##           Email    Call
## Call      2.9e-06 -
## Email + Call < 2e-16 < 2e-16
##
## P value adjustment method: bonferroni
```

Number of visits our website

Grouped by sales method, in the last 6 months



Buissnes Metric: Adjusted Mean Revenue considering time and effort invested

Defining a buissnes metric that can be measurable by the team will help to follow-up the tendency of the revenue registered in this 6-week period strategy. So I defined a metric called “Adjusted Mean Revenue” (AMR) which consist in the mean revenue per customer, but adjusting this value by a difficult factor, this were determined by time consumed by the team depending on the strategy (5 for Email, 30 for Call and 10 for Email + Call). In this case the metrics were substancially different between the three groups. The AMR for the 6 week period were 16.093 with a standard deviation of 2.858.

Considering this value as a baseline the main objective to monitor in the future will be maintain this value with a range of two times the standard deviation, this means this tendency will be considered if the AMR weekly is between 10.377 and 21.809. I suggest to implement this value as a metric to confirm the effectiveness of the Email + Call method, considering that the Email method in the first week of the strategy was by far the most effective in terms of revenue.

[!h]

Table 7: Adjusted Mean Revenue Over Time

week	Call	Email	Email + Call
1	1.224715	17.58574	12.48799
2	1.515945	19.93681	14.55017
3	1.457541	18.56985	14.49161
4	1.772647	21.53913	16.99397
5	1.819722	21.53689	17.43793
6	2.248925	25.59361	20.59621
Total	1.642924	19.37901	17.14774

[!h]

Table 8: Adjusted Mean Revenue for Email + Call

Mean	Standard Deviation
16.09298	2.857984

Conclusions and Recommendations

As a final summary:

- The Email + Call method were the most stable with a healthy increase over the weeks.
- The Email method generated the highest revenue just in the first week, and then it were decreasing over the time.
- The Call method is the weakest of the three with the lowest revenue generated and the more time consuming versus the other methods.
- The Adjusted Mean Revenue is a metric that can help the effectiveness of method implemented over time with a baseline of 16.093.